

Asa Gayle
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Dear staff at the College of Engineering,

I am writing to you today to express interest in your Application Programmer Associate position at the College of Engineering. I am a software engineer with nearly 5 years of corporate experience (Microsoft) and a year and a half working at another educational institution doing similar work with web technologies (Florida A&M University). I am passionate about programming, learning and growing in multiple different disciplines and this opportunity aligns with my desire to work with a large variety of technologies and on something that I can actively see the impact it makes on making others lives easier or more convenient.

During my time as a Software Engineer at Microsoft I primarily focused on cloud technologies (Kubernetes) and creating developer tooling to help devs easily migrate their monolithic systems to distributed systems on AKS (Azure Kubernetes Service). This included working in several languages (Go, Python, TypeScript) on things like command line tools, visual studio code extensions, kubernetes controllers and plugins and occasional front end work to display and enable new features the team and I created. All of this work included using internal git based proprietary tooling but also included some open source work hosted on Github.

While pursuing my MSc in Computer Science at Florida A&M University I interned at AutoDesk where I worked with the AutoCAD Web team on optimizing their large, React based application for different types of interaction vectors (dragging components and mobile/touch interfaces).

Lastly, before my MSc I also worked at Florida A&M University as a Web Developer where I created internal forms and systems using web technologies (HTML, CSS, JS, React) to update older paper based processes to a more modern approach. I worked with university stakeholders (top officials, professors, etc) by holding requirements meetings where I'd gather information about their needs and translate that into actionable development tasks for the team. I also installed the systems we built as well as several other pre-existing tools for university staff in different locations while ensuring they understood how to use them.

My experiences and passions have led to me being a focused and efficient worker who's able to learn quickly and get to the point of producing value fast and efficiently. Thank you again for considering me and I hope I can help create the best experience for everyone at the Marshal Family School of Education!

Sincerely,

Asa Gayle

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 4.5 years experience working in large tech firms spanning distributed systems/ platform engineering work in Golang (occasionally in Python) to React based frontend development in TypeScript. Has led the development of important features to tooling and plugins in Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS) focused primarily around developer experience. Currently seeking backend and fullstack focused roles.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Golang, TypeScript/JavaScript, Python

Skills and Tools: Azure, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Kubernetes (K8s), Docker, gRPC, React, Git, Github Actions, CI/CD, MySQL, NoSQL, gRPC, Terraform, Azure DevOps, Pipelines, Kusto (KQL)

Core Competencies: DevOps, Cloud, Automation, Distributed Systems, Software Engineering, Problem Solving, Mentorship

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer	Microsoft	June 2020 – February 2025
- Led development for feature to enable app-routing-operator plugin for AKS in air gap clouds. Plugin allowed large AI customer train models on private clouds using the plugging to manage ingresses. (Go) - Created features for app-routing-operator plugin that allowed for control of nginx ingresses by customizing the CRD, making it easier to redeploy changes. (Go, Kubernetes) - Created alerts for monitoring the status of internal and external AKS app-routing-operator deployments. Reduced false positive alerts by 13%. (KQL, Go) - Created and refactored several GitHub Actions and Azure Pipelines to allow users to create workflows that set context for kubeconfigs and secrets for managed and unmanaged K8s clusters (Go, CI/CD) - Created features for software that automates Kubernetes asset creation (helm charts, manifests, deployments, etc) via AKS DevHub, VSCode extensions and CLI applications (Go, TypeScript) - Regularly took on-call shifts to monitor the health and uptime of several services in Azure Kubernetes Service and addressed customer concerns via several methods (Teams, email, video calls, etc)		
Software Engineer Intern	Autodesk	June 2019 – August 2019
- Added drag and drop features to several components in AutoCAD Web including internal components and blocks. Eliminated need to open files via file explorer pop-up and allowed for uploading via dragging external files to the window. (TypeScript, React) - Converted ReactDnd's webhooks style functions to cross compatible wrappers that easily enabled drag and drop features for any components in the codebase. (TypeScript, React)		
Web Developer	Florida A&M University	April 2017 – August 2018
- Configured several new computer systems, moving the university from paper-driven business processes to an electronic document management system, reducing transaction times by at least 65%. - Created eForms for the Perceptive Content client with JavaScript, HTML and CSS		

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc in Interdisciplinary Studies (Computer Science/Music) | Florida A&M University, Tallahassee, FL 2016
MSc in Computer Science | Florida A&M University, Tallahassee, FL 2020